

H3 Prompt Composer

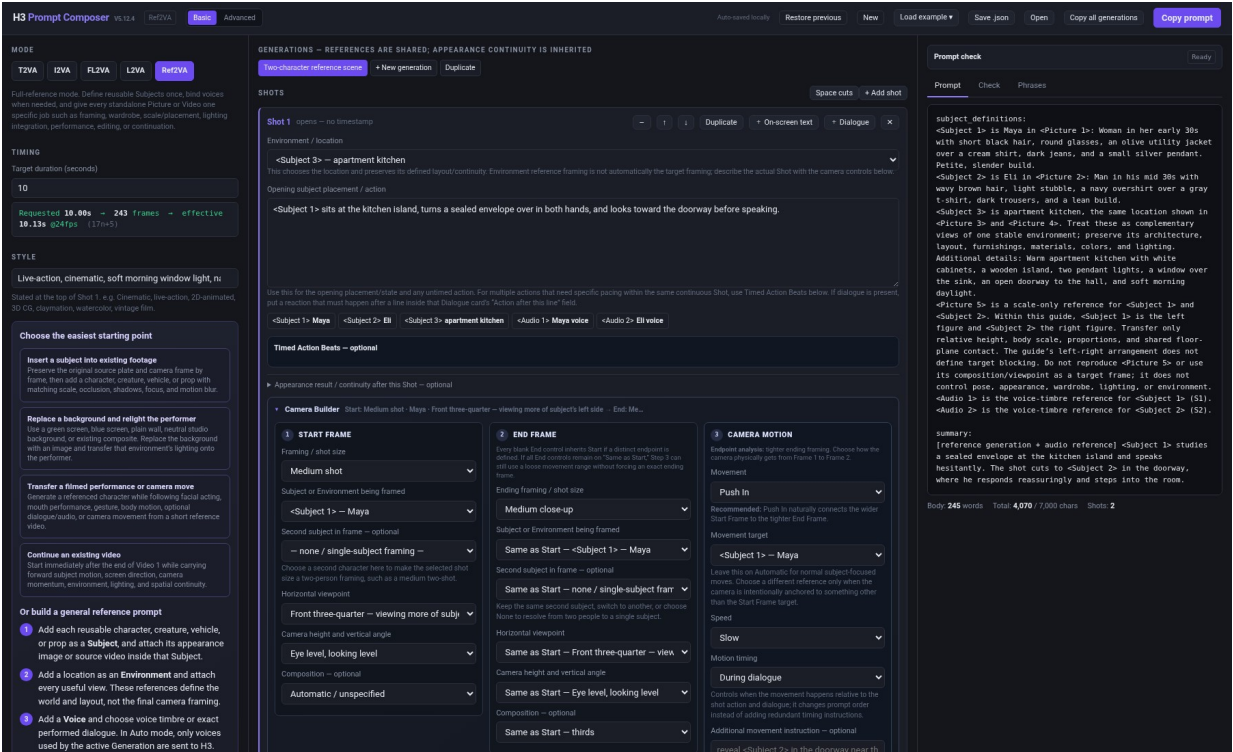
Illustrated User Guide

V5.12.4

A visual guide to references, Shots, continuity, editing, performance transfer, and continuation workflows.

1. Quick Start

1. Choose the correct H3 mode.
2. Set target duration and visual style.
3. Add only the Subjects/references that have a clear job.
4. Build the Generation; add Shots only for real cuts/transitions.
5. Describe action, Timed Beats, camera, dialogue, and sound.
6. Read Prompt Check.
7. Copy the prompt into H3/ComfyUI.



V5.12.4 overview: setup/workflows left, Shot Builder center, generated prompt/check panel right.

2. The Mental Model

Level	Meaning	Create a new one when...
Generation	One H3 output	Making the next clip
Shot	One continuous camera view	The camera actually cuts/changes view
Timed Action Beat	Timed action inside one Shot	Pacing changes without a cut

Do not create fake Shots for pacing If the camera stays continuous, keep one Shot and use Timed Action Beats.

Modes at a glance

Mode	Use it for
T2VA	Text-only video
I2VA	Picture 1 is the first frame
FL2VA	Picture 1 -> Picture 2
L2VA	Picture 1 is the final frame
Ref2VA	Subjects, Environments, Pictures, Videos, Audio, editing, transfer, continuation

3. Subjects and References

A Subject is a reusable character/person, creature, vehicle, prop, Environment, or other visible element. Attach identity/appearance images inside the Subject. The optional source-video area appears only when Video inputs are configured.

Subject source images and the beginning of the current-Generation appearance controls.

One reference, one job Use standalone Pictures only for a separate role: framing/storyboard, wardrobe, Environment state, scale/placement, lighting integration, or an exact frame anchor.

4. Appearance for This Generation

Starting look for this Generation is the authoritative opening appearance. The fields below it always edit the look the current Generation is actually using.

▼ Appearance for this Generation

This section controls what H3 should see at the **START** of the **current Generation**. The fields directly below always belong to the selected Starting look. A fresh Generation inherits the carried-forward look from the Generation you create it from; you can change it here when wardrobe changes off camera between clips.

Starting look for this Generation

Evening Wardrobe ▼

This Generation is explicitly using the selected saved look. To reuse any older look, simply choose it here; a separate "Recall" control is not needed.

+ New look for this Generation

Starts as: Evening Wardrobe Carries forward unchanged as Evening Wardrobe.

Starting look name

Evening Wardrobe

Type a new name; then press Enter or click Rename. The Starting look dropdown above updates immediately when the rename is committed.

Rename

How is this Starting look defined?

Text description — override wardrobe / temporary appearance ▼

Starting wardrobe / temporary appearance used in this Generation

Black T-shirt and blue jeans, no jacket. Hair, face, and body proportions remain unchanged.

This text belongs to the selected Starting look above. It overrides conflicting wardrobe or temporary-appearance details from the base character sheet while identity, face, hair, and body proportions remain anchored by the Subject reference.

▶ Saved looks library / historical editing

A new Evening Wardrobe look defined as a text override.

- Click + New look for this Generation when wardrobe changes between clips.
- Press Enter or click Rename to commit the new name and refresh the dropdown.
- The Saved looks library manages reusable states; it does not select the current look.
- Historical safety prevents later edits from silently rewriting earlier Generations.

5. Height, Scale, and Placement

Use text-only height when it is enough. Use a visual guide when stronger size information or rough placement is needed.

The screenshot shows the 'Picture' control settings in the H3 Prompt Composer. At the top, there's a header 'Maya and Eli height reference' with a green 'auto definition' button. Below this, a dropdown menu is set to 'Visual height / scale / placement — attribute guide'. A text box explains: 'This Picture is an attribute guide, not an exact frame. Scale-only mode transfers height, body scale, proportions, and floor-plane information globally. Scale + placement additionally transfers approximate blocking for one chosen Shot. The prompt explicitly tells H3 not to reproduce the guide's pose, lighting, rough composite, or exact composition.' Below this is a 'Short name' field containing 'Maya and Eli height reference'. A larger text box provides further context: 'Use a deliberately utilitarian scale diagram for scale-only work. A rough composite can also be used when you intentionally want approximate placement in one Shot. In either mode this Picture is guidance, never an exact target frame.' The 'Connected Picture used for this scale / placement reference' is set to 'Picture 5', with a note to 'Choose the actual ComfyUI Picture input containing the scale diagram or rough placement composite.' There are two character selection dropdowns: 'Character shown on the left' set to '<Subject 1> — Maya' and 'Character shown on the right (optional)' set to '<Subject 2> — Eli'. The 'Use this image for this Generation' dropdown is set to 'Height / scale + approximate placement'. The 'Placement applies to' dropdown is set to 'Shot 1'. Finally, an 'Additional scale / placement notes (optional)' text box contains the text: 'Keep the subject about this large and this deep in Shot 1; ignore the guide's pose, lighting, and rough'.

Scale-only is safest; scale + placement can guide approximate blocking/depth for one selected Shot.

Not an exact frame The guide should not control pose, lighting, rough mask edges, image style, or exact composition.

6. Build the Shot, Then the Camera

Use Opening subject placement / action for the opening state and untimed action. Add Timed Action Beats for paced actions without a cut. Then let Camera Builder own framing and movement.

Camera Builder Start: Medium shot · Maya · Front three-quarter — viewing more of subject's left side — End: Me...

1 START FRAME

Framing / shot size

Medium shot

Subject or Environment being framed

<Subject 1> — Maya

Second subject in frame — optional

— none / single-subject framing —

Choose a second character here to make the selected shot size a two-person framing, such as a medium two-shot.

Horizontal viewpoint

Front three-quarter — viewing more of subj

Camera height and vertical angle

Eye level, looking level

Composition — optional

Automatic / unspecified

2 END FRAME

Every blank End control inherits Start if a distinct endpoint is defined. If all End controls remain on "Same as Start," Step 3 can still use a loose movement range without forcing an exact ending frame.

Ending framing / shot size

Medium close-up

Subject or Environment being framed

Same as Start — <Subject 1> — Maya

Second subject in frame — optional

Same as Start — none / single-subject fram

Keep the same second subject, switch to another, or choose None to resolve from two people to a single subject.

Horizontal viewpoint

Same as Start — Front three-quarter — view

Camera height and vertical angle

Same as Start — Eye level, looking level

Composition — optional

Same as Start — thirds

3 CAMERA MOTION

Endpoint analysis: tighter ending framing. Choose how the camera physically gets from Frame 1 to Frame 2.

Movement

Push In

Recommended: Push In naturally connects the wider Start Frame to the tighter End Frame.

Movement target

<Subject 1> — Maya

Leave this on Automatic for normal subject-focused moves. Choose a different reference only when the camera is intentionally anchored to something other than the Start Frame target.

Speed

Slow

Motion timing

During dialogue

Controls when the movement happens relative to the shot action and dialogue; it changes prompt order instead of adding redundant timing instructions.

Additional movement instruction — optional

reveal <Subject 2> in the doorway near th

Describe only something not already established by the End Frame.

► Stability, lens, and focus

CAMERA INSTRUCTION PREVIEW

A medium shot frames <Subject 1> from the waist up, with the camera at a front three-quarter angle favoring <Subject 1>'s left side. The camera is at eye level. During the dialogue, the camera slowly pushes in toward <Subject 1>, tightening to a medium close-up, with smooth stabilized movement.

Camera Builder: Start Frame -> End Frame -> compatible Camera Motion.

- End Frame can inherit Start or change independently.
- Choose camera timing that matches the actual chronology.
- Direct source-video edits preserve the source camera and suppress Camera Builder instructions.

7. Dialogue and Audio

Dialogue cards keep speaker, spoken words, delivery, voice behavior, and post-line action in playback order.

(S1) Maya

Speaker

<Subject 1> - Maya

Voice: <Audio 1> - applied automatically from the subject binding.

quietly, with a hesitant pause before the final words

English

Spoken words only

I don't think I'm ready to open it.

► Action after this line - optional

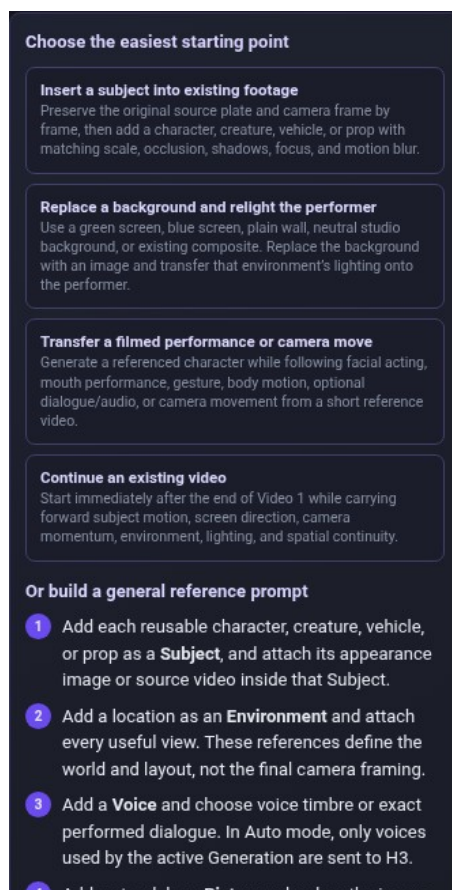
► Advanced dialogue settings

Dialogue lives in the Shot; voice references are bound at the Subject/reference level.

- Voice timbre generates new speech in the referenced voice.
- Exact performed dialogue reuses recorded words, timing, cadence, emotion, pauses, and pronunciation.
- Auto bypasses an unused voice so it does not consume an H3 Audio label.
- Music/SFX references use Active / Bypass, not voice-only Auto behavior.

8. Guided Video Workflows

Use the four guided starting points when an existing Video has a specific job. The Composer applies the correct source-ownership logic automatically.



Insert Subject, Background + Relight, Performance/Camera Transfer, and Video Continuation.

Editing vs continuation Editing changes something inside the existing source frames. Continuation begins after Video 1 ends and carries the final state forward.

9. Insert a Subject Into Existing Footage

Video edit preset: Insert subject into footage Leave preset

Connect the untouched source footage as **Video 1** and the inserted subject's appearance image as **Picture 1**. The generated prompt treats the original frames as the source plate, not merely as a visual reference.

Inserted subject name: Subject type:

Appearance details from the reference image

Lean red fox with russet fur, black lower legs, white chest and tail tip, natural adult proportions, and alert ears.

Depth in the source scene: Source audio treatment:

What the inserted subject does

moves naturally through the existing scene

☒ Preserve source footage frame for frame ☒ Use existing objects as occluders

☒ Ground feet/wheels and add contact shadow ☒ Match lighting, focus, grain, and motion blur

Use **What the inserted subject does** for the main path/blocking through the source footage. Use the Shot action below only for additional behavior or timing that is not already stated here. The preset supplies source-plate preservation and VFX-integration language automatically.

Video 1 is the source plate; Picture 1 defines the inserted Subject.

- Choose foreground, midground, or background depth.
- Describe the main path/blocking in What the inserted subject does.
- Use source objects as occluders; ground the Subject and match contact shadow, focus, grain, lighting, and motion blur.
- Use a rough scale/placement composite when size or approximate blocking needs stronger guidance.

10. Background Replacement + Relighting

Replace the source background while preserving the performer, or relight an already-composited video whose background is correct but whose performer still looks like studio footage.

MODE

T2VA I2VA FL2VA L2VA **Ref2VA**

Full-reference mode. Define reusable Subjects once, bind voices when needed, and give every standalone Picture or Video one specific job such as framing, wardrobe, scale/placement, lighting integration, performance, editing, or continuation.

TIMING

Target duration (seconds)

10

Requested 10.00s → 243 frames → effective 10.13s @24fps (17n+5)

STYLE

Live-action, cinematic

Stated at the top of Shot 1. e.g. Cinematic, live-action, 2D-animated, 3D CG, claymation, watercolor, vintage film.

Video edit preset: Background replacement + relighting Leave preset

Connect the performer footage as **Video 1** and the replacement environment image as **Picture 1**. A chroma screen is not required: choose the source-background type below so the prompt can describe what should be removed. If one pass replaces the background but preserves studio lighting, switch to **Relight existing composite only** and use the first output as Video 1.

Workflow stage: **Replace background** Original background: **Green screen**

Performer name: **the performer** Lighting change strength: **Strong and clearly v**

Performer details to preserve

Preserve facial identity, hairstyle, navy jacket, body proportions, hand gestures, timing, and lip

Replacement environment details

Rainy nighttime city alley with dark brick walls, wet pavement, storefront reflections, light haze, and deep background perspective.

Lighting visible in the environment image

Cool cyan key from frame left, warm amber rim from frame right, soft reflected light from wet pavement, and deep but readable shadows.

Describe direction, color, contrast, rim light, shadow depth, and reflected bounce when they are visually clear.

Background + Relight preset

preferred lighting integration look auto definition

What does this image control?

Lighting integration only – relighting look

This Picture transfers lighting integration only. Use a preferred composite/relight still to show key, fill, rim, reflected color, shadow density, exposure balance, and atmospheric integration. It does not control pose, framing, subject position, or background geometry.

Short name

preferred lighting integration look

Apply lighting look to

<Subject 1> – the performer

Lighting qualities to transfer

Transfer only the key/fill/rim relationship, reflected environment color, shadow density,

Optional Lighting / Integration Reference

- Choose the original background type and visible lighting direction/strength.
- Relight existing composite only is useful for an After Effects composite or the output of a first H3 pass.
- The Lighting / Integration Reference transfers key/fill/rim, reflected color, shadow density, exposure balance, and atmosphere - not pose or framing.

11. Performance Transfer and Video Continuation

These two workflows both use Video 1 as guidance, but they do very different jobs.

Reference workflow: Transfer performance or camera

Leave preset

Connect the target character sheet as **Picture 1** and the filmed performance/camera reference as **Video 1**. If Video 1 has useful synchronized speech, its paired soundtrack can optionally provide exact dialogue or voice timbre; audio is not required. The video can transfer facial acting, gesture, body motion, timing, and/or camera movement. This generates the referenced character; it does not composite the source performer or scene.

Target character

Dialogue / audio treatment

Target character

No dialogue / no au

Appearance details to preserve

Oval face, short dark hair, charcoal jacket, slim build, and the small scar above the right eyebrow.

Use Video 1 for

Performance only

Camera only

Performance + camera

☒ Facial expression

☒ Mouth performance

☒ Head movement

☒ Eyeline

☒ Upper-body gesture

☐ Full-body motion

☐ Camera movement

Performance notes

Transfer the hesitant delivery, brief downward glance, hand tremor, shoulder movement, and

Audio inactive disabled for this generation

No dialogue is required. Video 1 can still transfer facial acting, gesture, body motion, timing, and camera movement without creating or reusing a spoken line.

Performance transfer with no dialogue/audio

Reference workflow: Continue an existing video

Leave preset

Connect the clip you want to continue as **Video 1**. The final moment of that video becomes the handoff into the new generation. This is not a frame-for-frame edit: the source ends, then the target video continues forward from its final state. Add Character / Subject references below only when you want stronger identity control.

<Video 1> continuation handoff

Preserve the ending state, then create new motion after it rather than replaying the source.

Continue subject state, movement, and screen direction

☒

Continue camera direction, speed, height, and framing momentum

☒

Preserve environment, lighting, atmosphere, and spatial continuity

☒

Do not replay, restage, or reset the ending action

☒

Handoff notes – optional

The clip ends with her left foot forward and the camera tracking backward; keep that stride and camera momentum continuous before she slows

Describe only the new action that happens after the source ends in the Shot action box. Camera Builder can be used when the continued camera deliberately evolves after the handoff.

Continuation handoff from the final source moment

- Performance Transfer: choose exactly which acting/body/camera attributes transfer. The target Subject remains authoritative for identity/appearance.
- Dialogue is optional; movement/acting/camera transfer can use No dialogue / no audio reference.
- Continuation: carry Subject momentum/screen direction, camera momentum, Environment/lighting/spatial continuity, and prevent replay/reset of the ending.
- Use Handoff notes for exact body, camera, eyeline, or prop state at the source ending.

12. Appearance Changes on Camera

Describe the visible change where it happens. Use the appearance-result control only to record what state should carry forward.

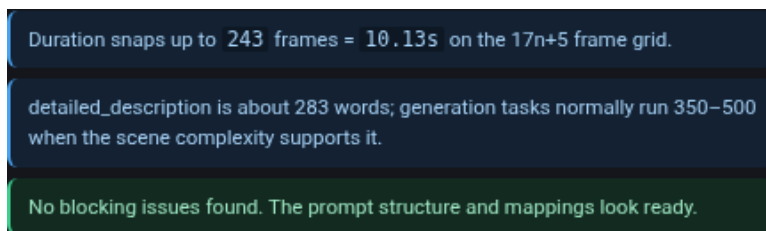
Example Action: She removes her jacket and drapes it over the chair. | Appearance after this Shot: Jacket Off

- The Shot start appearance is inherited automatically.
- Choose only the resulting appearance after the Shot.
- If the action makes the result obvious, the Composer does not add a redundant sentence such as "she has no jacket at the end."
- A later Shot can get a short continuity cue; a new Generation inherits the resulting look.

Generations and continuity

- New generation carries appropriate appearance, base soundscape, and music forward.
- Generation-specific extra sounds reset.
- Workflow-specific edit/continuation references do not bleed into unrelated fresh Generations.
- Duplicate keeps the current setup when you want a variation.

13. Prompt Check, Copy, and Save



Prompt Check is a preflight panel: Error = fix, Warning = review, Info = guidance.

- Copy prompt copies the active Generation.
- Copy all generations copies the sequence.
- Save .json exports the editable project; Open loads it later.
- Auto-saved locally stores the current project in browser local storage.
- Restore previous recovers the safety backup made before destructive changes.

Local tool The Composer itself does not upload your ComfyUI media or require a server connection.

14. Troubleshooting and Cheat Sheet

Symptom	Check first
Wrong voice	Identity and Voice Map; Subject/dialogue binding
Old wardrobe returns	Starting look for this Generation
On-camera wardrobe state is lost	Visible action + Appearance after this Shot
Characters merge/swap	Distinct clean Subject refs; anti-merge guard
Environment shifts	All Environment views must show the same place
Inserted Subject scale drifts	Visual scale/placement guide
Relight looks flat/tinted	Directional lighting notes or Lighting Integration reference
Continuation repeats ending	No-replay/reset + precise Handoff notes
Second action is rushed	Timed Action Beats
Prompt feels too long	Remove repetition; one clear job per reference

Five rules worth remembering

- Define reusable things once where they belong.
- Give every reference one clear role.
- Use Shots for cuts; Timed Action Beats for pacing.
- Let Camera Builder own camera language when possible.
- Run Prompt Check before copying the prompt.

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